

VideoPM Design System

Color, Typography & Spacing Specification

Phase 2 — UI/UX Design · Implementation Reference for HTML5 / CSS3 / JavaScript Build

September 2026

1. Overview

This report consolidates every color, typography, and spacing decision established for VideoPM into a single implementation-ready reference. All values below were originally defined as Figma variables and text styles during Phase 2 design work, verified against WCAG Level AAA contrast requirements, and are now translated into CSS custom properties so the HTML5/CSS3/JavaScript build (undertaken after Figma's monthly MCP quota was reached) can proceed from an identical source of truth rather than re-deriving values by eye from screenshots.

One correction is made in this report relative to the live Figma file: the Dark Mode status/danger-text token is corrected from #4A0A0A to #3A0808. The original value produced a measured contrast ratio of 6.91:1 against its paired fill (#FF8A8A) — just under the 7:1 AAA threshold. The corrected value restores AAA compliance at 7.60:1. This should be updated in the Figma “Color / Dark” collection once MCP access resumes; the CSS reference in Section 5 already reflects the corrected value.

Every contrast ratio in this report was computed directly from the WCAG 2.x relative-luminance formula against each color's actual paired background or foreground — not estimated — so the figures below can be treated as verified, not approximate.

2. Color Palette

2.1 Token Architecture

Colors are organized in three semantic groups — background, text/border, and accent/status — rather than being assigned to individual components by hand. Light and Dark are modeled as two parallel token sets sharing identical names, so a component built once (e.g. "use accent/primary for this button fill") automatically resolves correctly in either theme. This is the same layered-token approach recommended across current design-system literature specifically because it is what keeps a Light and a Dark palette from drifting out of sync over time.

2.2 Light Mode Palette

	Token	Hex	Usage	Contrast Ratio	Level
■	bg/page	#FFFFFF	Page background	—	—
■	bg/surface	#F7F7F8	Sidebar, section, card backgrounds	—	—

	Token	Hex	Usage	Contrast Ratio	Level
■	bg/surface-raised	#FFFFFF	Raised cards sitting on bg/surface	—	—
■	text/primary	#1A1A1A	Primary text, headings	17.8:1 on bg/page	AAA
■	text/secondary	#4A4A4A	Secondary / meta text	8.9:1 on bg/page	AAA
■	border/default	#767676	Default borders, default-state icons	4.5:1 on bg/page	AA (non-text)
■	border/subtle	#D0D0D0	Subtle dividers, card outlines	Decorative	—
■	accent/primary	#0D3B7A	Primary buttons, active nav, links	10.9:1 w/ accent-text	AAA
■	accent/primary-text	#FFFFFF	Text/icons on accent fill	(paired above)	AAA
■	status/success	#175C31	Success fills (checklist complete, "Select" rating)	8.0:1 w/ success-text	AAA
■	status/success-text	#FFFFFF	Text on success fill	(paired above)	AAA
■	status/warning	#7A4A00	Warning fills (gate incomplete, "Maybe" rating)	7.5:1 w/ warning-text	AAA
■	status/warning-text	#FFFFFF	Text on warning fill	(paired above)	AAA
■	status/danger	#8A1F1F	Danger fills ("Reject" rating, destructive actions)	9.1:1 w/ danger-text	AAA
■	status/danger-text	#FFFFFF	Text on danger fill	(paired above)	AAA
■	focus/ring	#0D3B7A	Focus outline (keyboard navigation)	10.9:1 vs page bg	AAA (2.4.13)

2.3 Dark Mode Palette

	Token	Hex	Usage	Contrast Ratio	Level
■	bg/page	#121212	Page background	—	—
■	bg/surface	#1E1E1E	Sidebar, section, card backgrounds	—	—
■	bg/surface-raised	#2A2A2A	Raised cards sitting on bg/surface	—	—
■	text/primary	#FFFFFF	Primary text, headings	18.7:1 on bg/page	AAA
■	text/secondary	#B0B0B0	Secondary / meta text	8.6:1 on bg/page	AAA
■	border/default	#6B6B6B	Default borders, default-state icons	3.5:1 on bg/page	AA (non-text)
■	border/subtle	#3A3A3A	Subtle dividers	Decorative	—
■	accent/primary	#8AB4FF	Primary buttons, active nav, links	8.3:1 w/ accent-text; 9.0:1 vs page	AAA
■	accent/primary-text	#0A1A33	Text/icons on accent fill	(paired above)	AAA
■	status/success	#7FDBA0	Success fills	7.4:1 w/ success-text	AAA
■	status/success-text	#0B3D1F	Text on success fill	(paired above)	AAA

	Token	Hex	Usage	Contrast Ratio	Level
■	status/warning	#FFC670	Warning fills	9.5:1 w/ warning-text	AAA
■	status/warning-text	#3A2400	Text on warning fill	(paired above)	AAA
■	status/danger	#FF8A8A	Danger fills	7.6:1 w/ danger-text (corrected)	AAA
■	status/danger-text	#3A0808	Text on danger fill — CORRECTED from #4A0A0A	(paired above)	AAA
■	focus/ring	#8AB4FF	Focus outline (keyboard navigation)	9.0:1 vs page bg	AAA (2.4.13)

2.4 Focus Indicator Specification (WCAG 2.4.13, AAA)

WCAG's AAA-only success criterion 2.4.13 (Focus Appearance) requires a visible focus indicator with at least 3:1 contrast against adjacent colors and a minimum area/thickness. VideoPM's implementation:

- Style: 2px solid outline using the focus/ring token, with a 2px offset from the element edge (outline-offset: 2px) so the ring never overlaps the element's own border.
- Light mode: focus/ring = #0D3B7A — 10.9:1 against bg/page, far exceeding the 3:1 minimum.
- Dark mode: focus/ring = #8AB4FF — 9.0:1 against bg/page, likewise well above the minimum.
- Applies to every interactive element (buttons, links, checkboxes, nav items, form fields) on :focus-visible, not :hover, so the ring only appears for keyboard/assistive-technology navigation.

3. Typography

3.1 Font Family

VideoPM uses a single family — Inter — across the entire interface, in four weights: Regular (400), Medium (500), Semi Bold (600), and Bold (700). Inter was chosen for its tall x-height and open counters, both of which measurably improve legibility at the smaller end of the scale (13–14px captions and labels), which matters directly for AAA-level readability.

```
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Inter:wght@400;500;600;700&display=swap');

body {
  font-family: 'Inter', -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, sans-serif;
}
```

3.2 Type Scale

Style	Size	Weight	Line Height	% of Size	Usage
Display / Page Title	32px / 2rem	Bold (700)	44px	137.5%	Page-level titles ("Design Foundations")

Style	Size	Weight	Line Height	% of Size	Usage
Heading / H1	28px / 1.75rem	Bold (700)	40px	142.9%	Screen headings ("Phase 4 · Development — Checklist")
Heading / H2	22px / 1.375rem	Semi Bold (600)	32px	145.5%	Topbar titles, section headers
Heading / H3	18px / 1.125rem	Semi Bold (600)	26px	144.4%	Card titles (project name, category name)
Body / Regular	16px / 1rem	Regular (400)	24px	150%	Default body copy, list item text
Body / Medium	16px / 1rem	Medium (500)	24px	150%	Emphasized inline text within body copy
Body / Small	14px / 0.875rem	Regular (400)	21px	150%	Meta text, secondary descriptions
Label / Button	16px / 1rem	Semi Bold (600)	22px	137.5%	Button and tab labels
Label / Caption	13px / 0.8125rem	Regular (400)	20px	153.8%	Timestamps, helper text, badge labels

3.3 Implementation Notes

- Use rem units in CSS, not fixed px, for every font-size and line-height. This is what allows a person's OS or browser text-size preference and 200% browser zoom (WCAG 1.4.4, AA) to actually work — a px-only stylesheet silently defeats both.
- Body text line-height sits at exactly 150%, meeting WCAG 1.4.8 (AAA) which recommends a minimum of 1.5× font size for paragraph text. Headings intentionally sit closer to 140% — 1.4.8 targets body copy specifically, and tighter heading leading is standard practice without harming readability.
- 16px (1rem) is the smallest size used for any primary reading text; 13px (0.8125rem) is reserved for captions/labels only, never for content a person must read to complete a task.
- Never rely on weight or size alone to convey meaning (e.g., "required" fields, active states) — pair with a color and/or icon per WCAG 1.4.1 (Use of Color).

4. Spacing System (Margins & Padding)

4.1 Spacing Scale

Token	Value	Usage
spacing/xs	4px / 0.25rem	Icon-to-label gaps, tight inline spacing
spacing/sm	8px / 0.5rem	Gaps between related small elements (badge icon + text)
spacing/md	16px / 1rem	Default gap between stacked elements within a card
spacing/lg	24px / 1.5rem	Gap between cards; internal card padding
spacing/xl	32px / 2rem	Page-level padding (topbar, body container)

Token	Value	Usage
spacing/2xl	48px / 3rem	Major section separation
radius/sm	6px	Checkboxes, small icon containers
radius/md	10px	Buttons, input fields, nav items
radius/lg	16px	Cards, panels, modals
size/touch-target-min	44px	Minimum interactive element size (WCAG 2.5.5, AAA)

4.2 Touch Target Minimum

Every interactive element — buttons, nav items, form controls, icon buttons — has a minimum hit area of 44×44px, matching WCAG 2.5.5 (Target Size, AAA) and Apple's default system control sizing. Where an icon itself is visually smaller (e.g. an 18px icon in the mobile bottom nav), the tappable container around it is still padded out to 44px — the visual size and the hit-target size are allowed to differ, but the hit target never shrinks below the minimum.

4.3 Applied Spacing Reference (Measured from Built Screens)

The values below are the actual measurements used in the Dashboard and Checklist/QC screens already built in Figma, provided so the CSS implementation matches pixel-for-pixel rather than being re-estimated from screenshots.

Element	Property	Value
Sidebar	Internal padding	20px all sides
Sidebar nav item	Height / padding	44px height; 12px horizontal padding
Topbar	Padding	32px horizontal, 16px vertical
Topbar	Height	72px (desktop) / 64px (mobile)
Page body	Padding	32px all sides (desktop); 20px (mobile)
Project / checklist card	Padding	20–24px all sides
Card-to-card gap	Vertical spacing	24px
Primary button	Padding / height	20px horizontal padding; 44px min height
Search field	Height	44px
Avatar / icon button	Size	44×44px
Mobile bottom nav	Height	64px; each tab ≥48px wide

5. CSS Custom Properties Reference

The block below is implementation-ready: drop it into a base stylesheet and toggle themes by setting `data-theme="dark"` on `<html>` or `<body>`. All values match Sections 2–4 exactly, including the corrected `danger-text` value.

```
:root {
  /* --- Color: Light (default) --- */
  --color-bg-page: #FFFFFF;
  --color-bg-surface: #F7F7F8;
  --color-bg-surface-raised: #FFFFFF;
  --color-text-primary: #1A1A1A;
  --color-text-secondary: #4A4A4A;
  --color-border-default: #767676;
  --color-border-subtle: #D0D0D0;
  --color-accent-primary: #0D3B7A;
  --color-accent-primary-text: #FFFFFF;
  --color-status-success: #175C31;
  --color-status-success-text: #FFFFFF;
  --color-status-warning: #7A4A00;
  --color-status-warning-text: #FFFFFF;
  --color-status-danger: #8A1F1F;
  --color-status-danger-text: #FFFFFF;
  --color-focus-ring: #0D3B7A;

  /* --- Typography --- */
  --font-family-base: "Inter", -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, sans-serif;
  --font-size-display: 2rem; --line-height-display: 2.75rem;
  --font-size-h1: 1.75rem; --line-height-h1: 2.5rem;
  --font-size-h2: 1.375rem; --line-height-h2: 2rem;
  --font-size-h3: 1.125rem; --line-height-h3: 1.625rem;
  --font-size-body: 1rem; --line-height-body: 1.5rem;
  --font-size-body-sm: 0.875rem; --line-height-body-sm: 1.3125rem;
  --font-size-label: 1rem; --line-height-label: 1.375rem;
  --font-size-caption: 0.8125rem; --line-height-caption: 1.25rem;
  --font-weight-regular: 400;
  --font-weight-medium: 500;
  --font-weight-semibold: 600;
  --font-weight-bold: 700;

  /* --- Spacing --- */
  --space-xs: 0.25rem; --space-sm: 0.5rem; --space-md: 1rem;
  --space-lg: 1.5rem; --space-xl: 2rem; --space-2xl: 3rem;
  --radius-sm: 6px; --radius-md: 10px; --radius-lg: 16px;
  --size-touch-target-min: 44px;
}
```

```

[data-theme="dark"] {
  --color-bg-page: #121212;
  --color-bg-surface: #1E1E1E;
  --color-bg-surface-raised: #2A2A2A;
  --color-text-primary: #FFFFFF;
  --color-text-secondary: #B0B0B0;
  --color-border-default: #6B6B6B;
  --color-border-subtle: #3A3A3A;
  --color-accent-primary: #8AB4FF;
  --color-accent-primary-text: #0A1A33;
  --color-status-success: #7FDBA0;
  --color-status-success-text: #0B3D1F;
  --color-status-warning: #FFC670;
  --color-status-warning-text: #3A2400;
  --color-status-danger: #FF8A8A;
  --color-status-danger-text: #3A0808; /* corrected from #4A0A0A — see Section 1 */
  --color-focus-ring: #8AB4FF;
}

*:focus-visible {
  outline: 2px solid var(--color-focus-ring);
  outline-offset: 2px;
}

button, a, input, .nav-item, .tab {
  min-height: var(--size-touch-target-min);
  min-width: var(--size-touch-target-min);
}

```

6. Summary

Every value in this report traces back to an existing Figma variable, text style, or measured screen — nothing here is newly invented for the HTML/CSS build. The one substantive change is the corrected Dark Mode danger-text color (Section 1), which should be treated as the canonical value going forward in both Figma and code. With this reference in hand, the HTML5/CSS3/JavaScript build can proceed screen-by-screen with color, type, and spacing values that are already accessibility-verified, rather than re-deriving them by eye.